

Luwei Ying

University of California, Los Angeles
Department of Political Science
3357 Bunche Hall
Los Angeles, CA 90095

✉ luweiying@ucla.edu
🌐 luweiying.org
🐦 [@luwei_ying](https://twitter.com/luwei_ying)
🔗 [Luwei-Ying](#)

Employment **University of California, Los Angeles**, Los Angeles, California
Assistant Professor, Political Science, July 2022–present
Faculty Affiliate, CSW Streisand Center, July 2023–present
Faculty Affiliate, California Center for Population Research, August 2023–present

Education **Washington University in St. Louis**, St. Louis, Missouri
Ph.D., Political Science, 2022
M.A., Political Science, 2018

Tsinghua University, Beijing, China
B.A., Journalism & Communication, summa cum laude, 2016
B.A., International Politics, 2016

Australian National University, Canberra, Australia
Exchange Program, 2014

Research Interests **International Relations:** International Security, Political Violence, Terrorism, Extremism, Political Communication
Political Methodology: Computational Text Analysis and Large Language Models, Open-Source Investigation, GIS, Causal Inference

Book Manuscript Ying, Luwei. *The Logic of Terrorist Propaganda*. Complete manuscript (nine chapters; 81,000 words).
– Book workshop held in April 2026 with Dara Kay Cohen (Harvard University), Rich Nielsen (Massachusetts Institute of Technology), and Paul Staniland (University of Chicago).

Publications Wayne, Carly, and Luwei Ying. “Gateways to White Nationalism: Leaders’ Online Rhetoric and Follower Engagement.” Forthcoming in *Journal of Politics*.

Ying, Luwei. 2026. “Military Power and Ideological Appeals of Religious Extremists.” *Journal of Politics*, 88(2), 666–680.
– Winner of the Best Poster Award (Application) at the 2020 PolMeth Summer Meeting, under the title “Religiosity and Secularism: A Text-as-Data Approach to Recover Jihadist Groups’ Rhetorical Strategies.”

	Carter, David B., Austin L. Wright, and Luwei Ying. 2025. "Population Displacement and State Building: The Legacies of Pashtun Resettlement in Afghanistan." <i>International Organization</i>, 79(4), 639–671. Abramson, Scott F., David B. Carter, and Luwei Ying. 2022. "Historical Border Changes, State Building and Contemporary Trust in Europe." <i>American Political Science Review</i>, 116(3), 875–895. Ying, Luwei, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Brandon M. Stewart. 2022. "Topics, Concepts, and Measurement: A Crowdsourced Procedure for Validating Topics as Measures." <i>Political Analysis</i>, 30(4), 570–589. Ying, Luwei. 2021. "How State Presence Leads to Civil Conflict." <i>Journal of Conflict Resolution</i>, 65(2–3), 506–533. – Winner of the Pi Sigma Alpha Award for the Best Paper Presented at MPSA 2019 – Winner of the Best Paper in International Relations Award at MPSA 2019 Carter, David B., and Luwei Ying. 2021. "The Gravity of Transnational Terrorism." <i>Journal of Conflict Resolution</i>, 65(4): 813–849.
Software	Ying, Luwei, Jacob M. Montgomery, and Brandon M. Stewart. 2023. "ValidateIt: Validating Topic Coherence and Topic Labels." https://CRAN.R-project.org/package=validateIt.
Working Papers	Blair, Christopher W., and Luwei Ying. "Building Walls, Building Bridges: Border Fortification and Insurgent Influence." Revise and resubmit, <i>International Organization</i>. Carter, David B., Luwei Ying, and Sadaf Vafa. "Historical Border Instability, Satisfaction with Democracy and the Rise of Populism." Under review. Carter, David B., Curtis S. Signorino, Christopher Lucas, and Luwei Ying. "Good Times, Bad Times: Left Censoring in Grouped Binary Duration Data." Vafa, Sadaf, and Luwei Ying. "Why Do Firms Fund Terrorism? Coercion, Ideology, and Extraction across 344,000 Firms in Seven Conflict Zones." Ying, Luwei. "Feeding the Fringe: How Mainstream Politics Fuels Extremist Mobilization."
Other Writings	Book Ying, Luwei. 2011. "Ice Toad: Stories about Chinese Militia in the 1920s." <i>Jilin People's Press</i>. Articles Ying, Luwei. 2015. "Rising of Digital Media Diplomacy: A Remedy for the Traditional Mode." <i>Chinese Market</i> 37: 125–127. Ying, Luwei. 2015. "On Wendt's Constructivism." <i>Journal of JUANZONG</i> 5(8): 635–635. Ying, Luwei. 2014. "Journalism during Chinese Communist Revolution." <i>Youth Journalist</i> 6: 86–87.

Honors & Awards	2024. Hellman Fellows Award for Outstanding Early-career Faculty, The Society of Hellman Fellows 2024. Deborah Gerner Award for Professional Development, International Studies Association 2023. Outstanding Article Award in International History and Politics, American Political Science Association 2022. Walter Isard Award for Best Dissertation, Peace Science Society (International) 2020. Best Poster Award (Application), Society for Political Methodology 2020. Pi Sigma Alpha Award for the Best Paper, Midwest Political Science Association 2020. Best Paper in International Relations Award, Midwest Political Science Association 2014. Best Paper in Social Sciences, People's Daily
Grants	2026. UCLA California Center for Population Research (CCPR) Seed Grant 2025. CSW Streisand Center Development Grants 2024. UCLA Luskin Center for History and Policy Research Grant 2024. Research Innovation Fund Grant, Initiative to Study Hate (ISH) 2024. The Council on Research Grant 2024-2025 2024. Center for European and Russian Studies (CERS) Grant 2023. CSW Streisand Center Faculty Research Grant 2021. American Political Science Association Annual Conference Travel Grant 2020. Weidenbaum Center Research Grant, with Carly Wayne 2020. Graduate Research Seed Grant 2020. Weidenbaum Center Research Grant, with Jacob M. Montgomery 2019. Peace Science Annual Conference Travel Grant 2019. American Political Science Association Annual Conference Travel Grant 2015. Overseas Studies Grant for Outstanding Undergraduates
Teaching	University of California, Los Angeles, Department of Political Science <i>Graduate Level</i> Pol Sci 239 Violent Non-state Actors in World Politics, Spring 2023, Spring 2024 Pol Sci 239 Studies on Terrorism, Fall 2024, Spring 2026 <i>Undergraduate Level</i> Pol Sci 139 Global Politics in Data, Fall 2026 (scheduled) Pol Sci 20 World Politics, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2026, Fall 2026 (scheduled)
Presentations	Annual Conferences APSA: 2019 (travel grant recipient), 2020, 2021 (travel grant recipient), 2022, 2023, 2026 (scheduled) MPSA: 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020 (cancelled), 2021, 2024, 2025 Peace Science: 2019 (travel grant recipient), 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023 PolMeth: 2019, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2024 Asian PolMeth: 2016, 2021 Latin American PolMeth: 2020 SLAMM! (St Louis Area Methods Meeting): 2019, 2021

CPAC (Comparative Politics Annual Conference): 2018, 2019, 2021
Visions in Methodology: 2021
WAPOR: 2024
IPSA: 2025

Invited Talks

2026: UC Berkeley
2025: Stanford, UChicago, USC
2024: CGU, Harvard, MIT, USC
2023: Stanford, [Political Science Review](#), Renmin (China), Zayed (UAE)
2022: Tsinghua (China)
2021: BU, Michigan, NYU Abu Dhabi (UAE), Princeton, Texas A&M, UBC (Canada), UCLA, UIUC, Vanderbilt
2020: [International Methods Colloquium](#), UCLA
2018: Tsinghua (China)

Workshops

SoCal PIPE Summer Workshop, Caltech, July 2026
Book Workshop for *The Logic of Terrorist Propaganda*, UCLA, April 2026
Borders, Territoriality and the State System, Washington University in St. Louis, March 2023
Women in Conflict Studies (WICS) Professional Development Workshop, February 2023
Political Science Speaker Series for Chinese Scholars [Virtual] Workshop, March 2022
Association for the Study of Religion, Economics, & Culture (ASREC) Graduate Student [Virtual] Workshop, Chapman University, June 2021
Weidenbaum Frontiers [Virtual] Workshop on Political Violence, Washington University in St. Louis, March 2021
Bayesian Inference in Political Science Workshop, Washington University in St. Louis, October 2019
Midwest Workshop in Empirical Political Science, Vanderbilt University, May 2019

Service

Manuscript Referee

American Political Science Review, *American Journal of Political Science*, *British Journal of Political Science*, *Conflict Management and Peace Science*, *International Organization*, *International Studies Quarterly*, *International Interactions*, *Journal of Conflict Resolution*, *Journal of Experimental Political Science*, *Journal of Peace Research*, *Journal of Politics*, *Landscape Research*, *Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics*, *Party Politics*, *Political Analysis*, *Political Research Exchange*, *Research & Politics*, *The Chinese Journal of International Politics*, *The Review of International Organizations*

Referee for

National Science Foundation
UK Research and Innovation (United Kingdom)
Institutional Review Boards, *Washington University in St. Louis*

Discipline

Selection Committee Member for the Empirical Studies of Conflict (ESOC) Annual Conference, 2024
Award Committee Member for the Outstanding Article Award in International History and Politics, American Political Science Association, 2024

PolMeth Poster Award Committee Member, 2022, 2023
Editor, PolMeth ListServ, Spring 2021 - Spring 2022

Departmental

International Relations Field Chair, UCLA Political Science, Fall 2025–present
Graduate Student Admissions Committee Member, UCLA Political Science, Winter 2022 and Winter 2024
Undergraduate Studies Committee Member, UCLA Political Science, 2024–present
Faculty Recruitment Committee Member, UCLA Political Science, Fall 2023
Field Paper Referee, UCLA Political Science, 2023–present
Coordinator, Speaker Series, WashU Political Science, Fall 2019–Spring 2022
Coordinator, Ph.D. students recruitment, WashU Political Science, Spring 2019

Advising

PhD Students

Sadaf Vafa (chair), Zhiqian Wu, Ryan Hironaka, Anya Sorensen

Undergraduate Students

John Porter, Carter Thompson, Kory Yueh, Harun Vemulapalli, William Gauvin, Tian Le Lim

RA Experience

Washington University in St. Louis, Office of the Chancellor
Research Assistant (Andrew D. Martin), Fall 2020

Work Experience

Xinhua News Agency, Beijing, China
Public Opinion Monitoring and Data Analysis, December 2014 – April 2015
Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, Beijing, China
Media Platforms Management, August 2015 – June 2016

Technical Skills

Computational Text Analysis: large language models, supervised text classification, multilingual corpora, language-model-assisted data collection
Open-Source Investigation: multilingual source collection, network analysis
Geospatial Analysis: ArcGIS, QGIS, spatial econometrics, satellite imagery, geolocation of texts
Programming: Python, R, SQL, Git, Linux, Stata, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Languages

Chinese (native), English (fluent), Arabic (basic)

Last updated August 30, 2026